SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #104 · GOD'S WILL & GUIDANCE

"Every decision has one right answer, and I must find it."

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Where it often comes from

Teaching that God has a specific choice for everything, down to what you eat. Perfectionism and fear of mistakes. Anxiety that turns small choices into crises. A home where mistakes were punished harshly. Comparing yourself with people who seem certain about everything.

What Scripture teaches

Some decisions are clearly right or wrong because Scripture speaks to them. But many choices are about freedom within God's good boundaries. Paul says whatever you eat or drink, do it all to the glory of God. Believers can come to different conclusions on some matters, each fully convinced in their own mind. God calls us to freedom, to serve one another in love, and to commit our works to Him. In many decisions, there are several good options.

> *"So whether you eat or drink or whatever you do, do it all to the glory of God"*
> **(1 Corinthians 10:31)**.

Also see

> "For you, brothers, were called to freedom; but do not use your freedom as an opportunity for the flesh. Rather, serve one another in love" **(Galatians 5:13)**.

> "One person regards a certain day above the others, while someone else considers every day alike. Each one should be fully convinced in his own mind" **(Romans 14:5)**.

> "Commit your works to the LORD and your plans will be achieved" **(Proverbs 16:3)**.

> "He has shown you, O man, what is good. And what does the LORD require of you but to act justly, to love mercy, and to walk humbly with your God?" **(Micah 6:8)**.

Common self-statements

- There's only one right choice, and I have to find it.
- If I choose wrong, God will be displeased.
- I can't decide until I'm sure it's the perfect choice.
- Every little decision matters eternally.
- I keep second-guessing everything.
- Other people always know the right answer.

Common logical errors

- **Perfectionism:** Believing every choice must be the perfect one.
- **All-or-nothing thinking:** Believing there is only one right answer and everything else is wrong.
- **Catastrophizing:** Treating small decisions as if they had huge consequences.
- **Rumination:** Replaying choices over and over.

Challenging questions

- Does Scripture speak directly to this decision?
- What does 1 Corinthians 10:31 say about everyday choices?
- Could there be more than one good option here?
- What does Romans 14:5 say about personal convictions?
- Am I using freedom to glorify God and serve others?
- What is the cost of endlessly searching for the perfect answer?
- What would happen if I chose a good option and moved on?

Truth summary

> Not every decision has only one right answer. When Scripture is clear, I follow it. In many choices, God gives me freedom to choose among good options. I can commit my plans to the Lord, do everything for His glory, serve others in love, and move forward without fear.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Will of God
- Wisdom
- Plans
- Anxiety/Worry
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Every decision has one right answer, and I must find it"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Every decision has one right answer, and I must find it." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Does Scripture speak directly to this?
- ☐ What does 1 Corinthians 10:31 say?
- ☐ Could there be several good options?
- ☐ What does Romans 14:5 say?
- ☐ Am I using freedom for God and others?
- ☐ What if I chose a good option and moved on?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Many decisions have more than one good option.
- ☐ I can do everything to the glory of God.
- ☐ God gives me freedom within His good boundaries.
- ☐ I can commit my plans to the Lord.
- ☐ I don't have to find the perfect choice.
- ☐ I can decide and move forward in peace.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **1 Corinthians 10:31**
  "So whether you eat or drink or whatever you do, do it all to the glory of God."
- [ ] **Galatians 5:13**
  "For you, brothers, were called to freedom; but do not use your freedom as an opportunity for the flesh. Rather, serve one another in love."
- [ ] **Romans 14:5**
  "One person regards a certain day above the others, while someone else considers every day alike. Each one should be fully convinced in his own mind."
- [ ] **Proverbs 16:3**
  "Commit your works to the LORD and your plans will be achieved."
- [ ] **Micah 6:8**
  "He has shown you, O man, what is good. And what does the LORD require of you but to act justly, to love mercy, and to walk humbly with your God?"

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Good-enough decision log:** Each day, write one decision I made, why it was a good option, and that I didn't second-guess it.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, Proverbs 16:3 becomes: "**Sarah** can commit **her** works to the LORD, and **her** plans will be achieved."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Plans" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **For your next small decision, set a two-minute limit,** choose a good option, and move on.
- ☐ **Write down a past decision you agonized over,** and list what actually happened.
- ☐ **Read Romans 14,** and write what Paul says about freedom and conviction.
- ☐ **Practice saying, "Either option is fine,"** about one choice this week.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Every decision has one right answer, and I must find it": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One decision I made without second-guessing
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Every decision has one right answer, and I must find it.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, thank You for the freedom You give me within Your good boundaries. Help me reject the lie that every decision has one right answer that I must find. Teach me to follow Your Word, commit my plans to You, and choose with peace. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.